Some Tips for Making Good Technical Presentation

Research Methodology

Ashish Choudhury (ASU, ISI Kolkata)

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(I have very poor communication skills)

Outline

- Things to think about
- A generic conference talk outline
- Academic interview talks
- Other talks

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- Tips to make a bad presentation

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       - Forecast --- what you are going to tell
       - Tell
       - Summarize --- what you told

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      - ii. Make forecast and summary accessible to all

Things to Think About - III

- Think about your rhetorical goals

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  - Depends upon the type of talk
  - Will consider each type of talk one by one …

Things to Think About - IV

- Practice in public

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  - Hard to distill work down to 20 or 30 minutes

Things to Think About - V

- Prepare the slides
  - Later in "Tips to make a bad presentation"

The Story So Far…

- Things to think about ✓
- A generic conference talk outline
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- Other talks
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A Generic Conference Talk Outline

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     - Presentation --- advertisement of the paper
     - Presentation --- not replacement of the paper

A Generic Conference Talk Outline

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  1. Clear picture of the gist of your contribution
  2. Make the audience to read your paper
     - Presentation --- advertisement of the paper
     - Presentation --- not replacement of the paper
     - Most of us try to make it a replacement

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  - One idea you want people to leave with ?

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- Outline --- 1 slide
  - Audiences like predictability

A Generic Conference Talk Outline

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  - Motivation and Problem Statement --- 1/2 slides
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  - Related work --- 1/2 slides
    - ➢ Cover superficially. Refer to the paper
  - Methods --- 1/2 slides
    - ➢ Cover quickly. Refer to the paper

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  - Main body of your talk
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  - Structure varies --- function of your contribution
  - Do not superficially cover all results
  - Cover key results well

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- Summary --- 1 slide

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- Future work --- 0/1 slide

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- Backup slides --- 0/3 slides
  - Not part of your main talk

A Generic Conference Talk Outline

- Summary --- 1 slide
- Future work --- 0/1 slide
- Backup slides --- 0/3 slides
  - Not part of your main talk
  - To answer expected questions like:
    - Ideas glossed over
    - Shortcomings of methods / results

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Academic Interview Talks

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- Two key audiences --- you have to reach both
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     - must be impressed with depth of your contribution
  2. Rest of the department
     - should understand your problem, why it is important

Academic Interview Talks

- Rhetorical goal different from conference talk
  - Conference talk --- get people interested in your paper and work
  - Intervi… part
- Two…
  1. Pe…
     - must be imp… of your contribution
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Both audiences will evaluate how well you speak as an approximation of how well you can teach.

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Other Talks

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  - Consider rhetorical purpose
  - Consider your audience
- Example: Project evaluation for a course
  - seeks to reach the professor first
  - fellow students second
  - Purpose: to impress and get good grade
  - Method part should be described in more details than conference talk

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Tips to Make a Bad Presentation

(9 Commandments --- Suggestions for 10th Welcome)

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1. Thou Shalt Not be Neat

- Why waste research time in preparing slides ?
- Ignore spelling, grammar and legibility
  - Who cares what 50 people think ?

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2. Thou Shalt Not Waste Space

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- Why to waste memory space ?
  - Easy to attach/send if less number of slides

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- Use complete sentences, not keywords
- If possible, use whole paragraphs and read it
  - ➢ Do you want to continue the stereotype that engineers can't write?

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4. Thou Shalt Not Write Large

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- Important people sit in the front

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4. Thou Shalt Not Write Large

- Important people sit in the front
  - Be humble --- use small fonts
  - Why to worry about others ?

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5. Thou Shalt Not Use Color

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- Unfair to emphasize some words over the others
- Flagrant use of color indicates uncareful research

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6. Thou Shalt Not Illustrate

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Wisdom from the ages ?

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OR



Turing award winner who first counted goto's ?

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7. Thou Shalt Not Make Eye Contact

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- Averts eyes to show respect

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7. Thou Shalt Not Make Eye Contact

- Averts eyes to show respect
- Blocking screen can add misery

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8. Thou Shalt Not Skip Slides in a Long Talk

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- You prepared the slides;
- People came for whole talk

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} Just talk faster

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- Skip your summary and conclusion if necessary

Tips to Make a Bad Presentation

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9. Thou Shalt Not Practice

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- Why waste research time for practicing a talk ?

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- How can you appear spontaneous if you practice ?

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- Why waste research time for practicing a talk ?
- How can you appear spontaneous if you practice ?
- Most important commandment
  - Even if you break remaining eight, this can save you

Take Home Message

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- Pleasure of giving away much higher than taking

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  - You will be inundated with joy
- Just do it once
  - You will be in the right path then onwards…

References

- Several online articles
- My personal favorites:

1. Oral Presentation Advise. Prof. Mark D. Hill, Computer Sciences Department, University of Wisconsin-Madison

2. How to Give a Bad Talk. Prof. David A. Patterson, Computer Science Division University of California-Berkeley.

Its time to wake up
(Chaa Time…)



Academic Interview Talks

- A possible algorithm --- does not guarantee a job!!
  - Take a 20 min conference talk
  - 5 min introduction → 20 min introduction
    - Drive home the problem, why is it importance and gist of what you have done
  - Rest of the talk – (summary + future work)
  - 10 mins of deeper stuffs from your thesis
    - To show your depth
  - 10 mins of deeper stuffs from your thesis